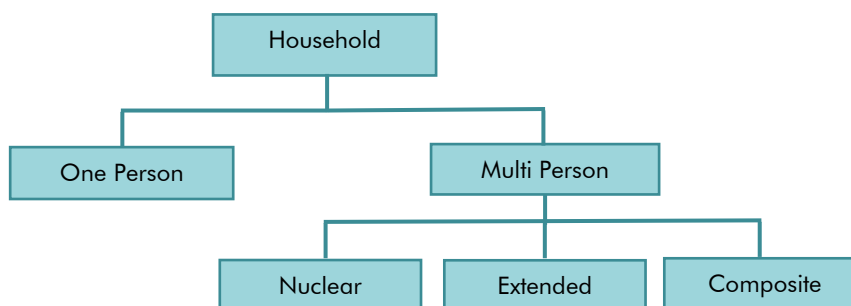


10.3 Types of Households

Types of households can be classified into four types based on the relationship to the head of the household. Accordingly, one-person households and the multi-person households which are further divided into three categories as follows.



Nuclear Household

A nuclear household is a household unit consisting only of parents (mother and father) and their unmarried children.

Extended Household

An extended household is a household consisting of a family unit that includes not only parents and children, but also paternal relatives/maternal relatives (such as paternal/maternal parents, paternal/maternal siblings, cousins, etc.)

Composite Household

A composite household category is a household consisting of a family unit living with individuals who are not relatives, either with a nuclear household or with an extended household, in the same housing unit.

10.4 Distribution of Household by Household Size

Table 10.1 : Percentage Distribution of Household Size by Sector, 2024

Sector	Total Number of Households	Household Size							Total	Average Household Size
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7 & Over		
Total	6,111,315	10.5	18.1	21.0	25.0	15.9	6.4	3.1	100.0	3.5
Urban*	1,045,665	10.6	17.7	20.5	25.8	15.1	6.4	3.9	100.0	3.5
Rural	4,827,055	10.4	18.2	21.3	25.0	15.9	6.3	2.9	100.0	3.5
Estate Rural**	238,595	11.4	17.8	19.0	21.6	18.3	7.5	4.4	100.0	3.6

* In 2024 information was collected separately for "Urban" and "Estate Urban" sectors, for comparison with the 2012 Census data, these two sectors have been combined and presented as "Urban".

** In the 2012 Census, the sector was identified as "Estate", whereas in the 2024 Census it is referred to as "Estate Rural."

The average household size in Sri Lanka is 3.5, and when considering each sector, the highest average household size of 3.6 is reported in the estate rural sector. The average household size in both urban and rural sectors is 3.5.

Among all household categories, one-person households account for 10.5 percent. In the estate rural sector, this proportion is slightly higher at 11.4 percent, representing the highest percentage among all sectors. Considering the distribution by household size, households comprising four members constitute the largest share, and this pattern is consistently observed across all sectors as well as at the national level.

The distribution of household size is broadly similar in the urban and rural sectors; however, the estate rural sector exhibits a distinct pattern, with a relatively higher percentage of larger households.